



ON SOLID GROUND Sanjiv Mehta,
Chairman & MD, Hindustan Unilever Ltd

Key Highlights

- ❶ HUL promptly addressed supply-chain issues when the Covid-19 pandemic hit
- ❷ Mehta's focus on innovation has kept the company at the top slot even as many new players entered the market
- ❸ Focus on 'winning in many Indias' has helped HUL grow across the country
- ❹ Mehta's interest in research and development has ensured the products go through a series of quality checks
- ❺ The merger with GSK Consumer Healthcare and a seamless transition has kept the numbers upbeat despite the pandemic's impact

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PHOTO BY RACHIT GOSWAMI

Beauty Lies in the Details

With years of experience in dealing with tough situations, Sanjiv Mehta is successfully rewriting HUL's growth story in challenging times

By **Arnab Dutta**

► **SANJIV MEHTA**, Chairman and Managing Director of Hindustan Unilever, was in Bhubaneswar a few years ago on a market visit. Soon after, the company's Executive Director of Research and Development, Vibhav R. Sanzgiri, got a call from his boss. Mehta noted that a variant of Lux soap was losing its fragrance sooner than expected in the humid conditions of the east. "Look, this can't be our Lux', I still recall him saying during a market visit at the beginning of 2019. These visits by top executives of FMCG companies are not new, but a top boss picking up products from the stands and figuring [out] minute differences is not very common," Sanzgiri says.

If you are a user of HUL's popular Dove skincare range or the newly launched sensitive toothpaste, you can rest assured that almost all of those have been offered to you only after Mehta was satisfied with their quality. A chartered accountant by